

Game development with JavaScript

Picking the best tools for game development

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From the ages of playing “Dave” on MS-DOS based machines to playing resource intensive games on bleeding edge hardware, computer games have come a long way. PC gaming has had intensive development over the years and have stayed in trend for a pretty long time now. Mobile games, though newer in comparison and very platform dependent, has seen its fair share of new work too. JavaScript games on the other hand had been fairly neglected until recently. Flash was often inconsistent, bulky, and prone to security violations, but the advent of HTML5 paired with high speed

internet connectivity today has made it possible to develop previously unimaginable, web browser backed games. Multiplayer, browser-based games are not only a big thing today, but they have also become so common that you possibly shall not even be able to distinguish them from your usual PC/mobile games.

In fact JS based games have the added advantage of being platform independent, thus allowing them to be run simultaneously across devices.

Phaser is a platform that facilitates the creation of 2D game framework for making HTML5 games for desktop and mobile.

WHY PHASER

The first step in this process is to pick a framework. Rather than going through the entire process, we’re going to tell you why we picked Phaser. For starters, Phaser is open source, but has a company behind it.

What that means is, you get the benefits of an open source platform

along with the support that a company brings. Along with that, Phaser is quite fast and easy to get started with. It also comparatively bug free, say, in comparison to something like Defold. With that out of the way, let us get on with the next step.

SETTING UP YOUR WORLD...

Installing a web server

Windows

We recommend a WAMP or XAMPP server for a Windows platform. WAMP installs an icon into your system-tray from which you can stop and restart the services, as well as modify Apache settings such as creating a new folder alias for a project.

Instead of an ‘all in one’ bundle you could also download just a web server on its own.

Note: If you use WAMP Server you may find that IE11 causes it to freeze.

OS X

Being a Unix environment at heart there are more options available on OS

*CODING MATTERS



*New governance model for Python

After Guido van Rossum abdicated his role as Python’s leader Python will in future be governed by a five-person Steering Council.
<https://digit.in/PySCouncil>



*MariaDB adds Node.js connector

The developers of MariaDB have released a connector for Node.js for the database allowing developers to build Node.js applications on top of MariaDB’s RDB.
<https://digit.in/NodeMaria>



*Eliminating swear words from OpenJDK

After concern was raised over “too many swear words” in the source code for OpenJDK, the issue was resolved after a courteous exchange of views.
<https://digit.in/OpenSwear>